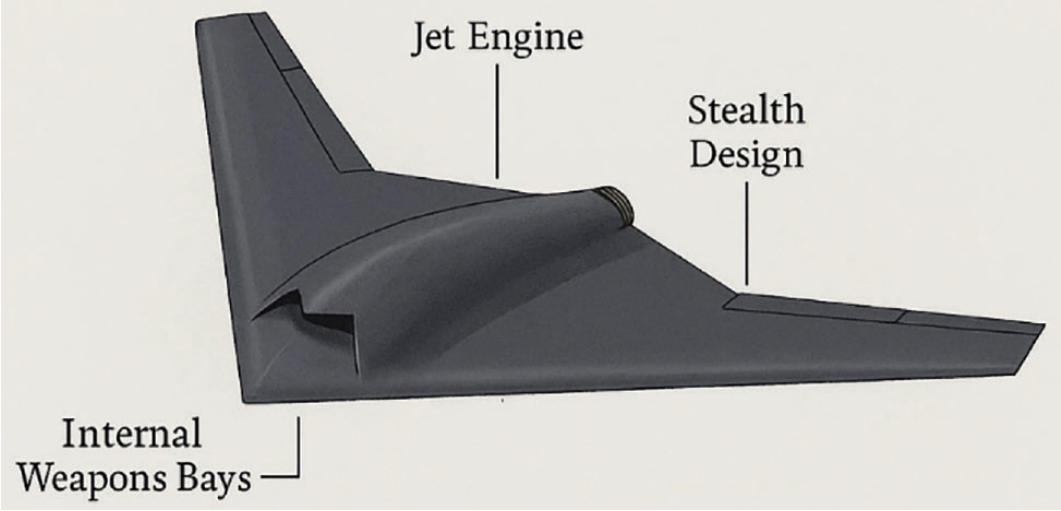


Figure 5.4 CH-7 Rainbow (2019).⏎

Key labeled features include the internal weapons bay, which enables the carriage of guided munitions and electronic warfare payloads without compromising stealth, and the multi-sensor suite, integrating synthetic aperture radar (SAR), electro-optical/infrared (EO/IR) systems, and signals intelligence (SIGINT) modules. The AI-enabled mission control system and autonomous flight management computer empower the UAV to perform realtime threat detection, navigation, and coordination with other aircraft.

This figure underscores the CH-7's role as China's first fully autonomous stealth combat drone, representing the country's leap into fourth-generation UAV design. It exemplifies the integration of AI, stealth technology, and modular mission architecture, positioning the CH-7 as a vital asset for strategic reconnaissance, precision strike, and electronic warfare in modern military operations.

5.6.2.3 Skyborg Program (2020)

The Skyborg Program, launched in 2020 by the US Air Force Research Laboratory (AFRL) and managed by the Air Force Life Cycle Management Centre (AFLCMC), represents one of the most ambitious steps toward the realization of AI-driven autonomous air combat systems. Rather than